



AFTER

The loss of Fort Donelson undermined the Confederate strategic position in the Western theater, leading to the loss of all of Kentucky and most of Tennessee.

CONFEDERATE WITHDRAWALS

With Grant advancing down the Tennessee River and under pressure from Buell's Army of the Ohio, **Albert Johnston abandoned Nashville** on February 23, handing the Tennessee state capital to the Union without a fight. The Confederate stronghold at **Columbus on the Mississippi was abandoned** shortly after. The withdrawn Confederate forces **concentrated at Corinth, Mississippi**. From there a **counter-offensive was mounted** that led to the [**Battle of Shiloh**](#) at Pittsburg Landing.

UNION VICTORY AT PEA RIDGE

Shortly after Fort Donelson, the Confederacy suffered another defeat in the Western theater. At the **Battle of Pea Ridge**, fought in **northern Arkansas** on March 6–8, 1862, a Confederate army under Major General Earl Van Dorn was **decisively defeated** by a **smaller Union force** commanded by Brigadier General Samuel Curtis.